



Above Colorful *trajineras* (gondolas) offer a unique way to tour Xochimilco, an Aztec site just outside Mexico City



Above Soft tacos – tortillas stuffed with spicy meat, beans, fresh vegetables, and jalapeño peppers – make a great picnic on the run

A Day in Mexico City

One day is precious little time in a city as large and interesting as Mexico City, but with careful planning and taco-fueled stamina, it's surprising how much can be enjoyed and achieved.

MORNING Start the day in the cultural heart of the **Centro Histórico**. In the huge main square (the **Zócalo**), take a guided tour of the ruined Aztec **Templo Mayor** and then drop into the **National Palace** to admire the Diego Rivera murals of revolutionary scenes.

AFTERNOON Take Line 2 of the metro as far south as it goes and change on to a Tren Ligero (light train) to explore the floating gardens of **Xochimilco**. It's best on a Sunday, when it's usually thronged with families and gaudily decorated barges. Join a punting trip and drift past lamb barbecues, mariachi musicians, and endless stalls.

EVENING Begin with alfresco drinks in **Plaza Garibaldi**. Then choose between a top-flight restaurant or a simple eatery, before hopping into a taxi to **Zona Rosa** for late-night clubbing; or head for home, stopping off for *churros* (see pp70–71) and chocolate on the way.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Benito Juárez International Airport is 10 miles (16 km) east of the city, around 30 minutes by authorized **taxi** or the **metro** (Line 5). Get around the city on the excellent metro or use the iconic VW Beetle “bug” taxis.

WHERE TO STAY

Casa de la Condesa (inexpensive) is a modern, clean, and comfortable hotel in Roma Norte. All rooms have kitchens. www.casadelacondesa.net
Hotel Casa Vieja (moderate) is a boutique gem in Polanco that offers luxurious suites and roof-terrace dining. www.casavieja.com
Condesa DF (expensive): minimalist design hotel in upmarket Condesa with a noted Japanese-fusion restaurant. www.condesadf.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.visitmexico.com